

Executive Summary

2025 was a pilot phase for the first coordinated anticipatory action (AA) framework in Afghanistan. Following the activation of the second window (Window B) in April 2025 and the subsequent implementation of activities, partners under the AA Framework for drought in Afghanistan convened an After-Action Review workshop in early 2026 (which reviewed evidence from the CERF-AHF and WFP after action review exercises). The workshop identified and discussed lessons learnt and actions for improvement ahead of the spring season. This updated framework reflects the resulting changes and collective agreements reached by AA partners and priorities of the Humanitarian Reset.

This document presents the framework for drought anticipatory action in Afghanistan. It entails coordinated packages of assistance planned to be delivered to people at risk of spring drought in Afghanistan across five prioritised spring rain and grain dependent provinces – Balkh, Faryab, Jawzjan, Sar-e-Pul, and Badghis. The framework was developed through a participatory process of humanitarian partners who formed an Anticipatory Action Group, coordinated by OCHA, under the overall leadership of the Deputy Special Representative of the Secretary-General/Resident Coordinator/Humanitarian Coordinator (DSRSG/RC/HC).

The financing

The Emergency Relief Coordinator has approved \$22 million combining pre-committed financing by the Central Emergency Response Fund (CERF) (\$12 million) and the Afghanistan Humanitarian Fund (AHF) (\$10 million) – with this being one of two AA frameworks globally that has been backed by both pooled funds. Payout of these funds will only occur if the pre-agreed trigger thresholds are reached. The funding will allow humanitarian partners to provide multi-purpose cash (\$11m) and in-kind and cash-based assistance across Agriculture and Livelihoods (\$4.25m), Health and Nutrition (\$3.65m), Protection (\$0.87m), and WASH (\$2.19m) sectors.

The trigger

The financing and activities included in this framework will be triggered by either the following:

- **Forecast-based trigger (window A):** If the March European Centre for Medium-Range Weather Forecasts (ECMWF) predicts March-May rainfall below a 1-in-6-year RP based threshold in the monitored area.
- **Observation and forecast-based trigger (window B):** If the composite indicator monitored in April breaches the 1 in 4 year return period threshold, in the monitored area. (details are in the trigger section below)

The combined overall return period for the full allocation is 1-in 4 years., a Historical activation details for the framework are shown in the table below¹.

Trigger Mechanism Statistics

Stats by trigger

Analysis years: 1984-2024

Trigger	Return period	Activation probability	Years activated
Window A	6.14 years	16%	1985, 2000, 2001, 2004, 2006, 2008, 2018
Window B	3.91 years	26%	2000, 2001, 2004, 2006, 2008, 2011, 2018, 2021, 2022, 2023, 2025

Overall stats

Overall return period 3.91 years

Overall probability of activation 26%

Average total spending per year 3.07 M

¹ Budget-related figures only include the CERF budget.

The "overall return period" corresponds to years where at least one of the windows activates.

The "average period for total budget spend" is the average period for the whole CERF framework budget (\$10M) to be spent on framework activations

The action plan

The framework will enable humanitarian partners to implement anticipatory activities in a coordinated manner. In line with the humanitarian reset, this revised framework advances multi-purpose cash assistance (MPCA) - preferred by people – and focuses on the most vulnerable – inter-sector severity 4 areas and populations in line with the hyper-prioritised 2026 [Humanitarian Needs and Response Plan \(HNRP\)](#). Activities covered by both CERF and AHF funding will be delivered either after the first trigger moment in March or the second trigger moment in April, with a large focus on MPCA (50%) and across livelihoods, WASH, nutrition, protection and Health sectors.

To promote choice and dignity among beneficiaries, and in response to feedback gathered through Afghanistan's Community Voices and Accountability Platform highlighting the affected people's strong preference for cash assistance, both CERF- and AHF-funded activities include MPCA and sectoral cash assistance. CERF funding will be made available to UN agencies while the AHF funding will exclusively cover national and international NGO partners. CERF and AHF have been deployed as complementary pooled funding mechanisms where comparative advantages of NGO and UN partners were maximised. For instance, under the nutrition sector, CERF financing will cover the provision of essential nutrition commodities and health supplies, while AHF funds international and national NGO partners to deliver and implement the corresponding activities, including the provision of RUTF, BSFP, and sexual and reproductive health services through mobile health teams. All activities identified are critical and align with the lifesaving criteria of the 2026 HNRP (Strategic objective 1) as well as CERF/AHF's lifesaving focus.

All activities under the framework will be implemented, if the trigger thresholds for the cluster of five provinces is reached. The pre-agreed actions will focus on the following modalities:

- **Cash and Voucher Assistance:** This includes Multi-Purpose Cash Assistance (MPCA) aimed at strengthening household-level drought preparedness based on self-identified priorities, as well as cash+ and sector-specific cash modalities for livestock protection and community-level water conversation and rehabilitation.
- **Communicating risks, engaging with communities, and early warning messaging:** early warnings, community disease prevention and hygiene messaging.
- **Providing in-kind assistance:** including livestock protection inputs, emergency medical, dignity and hygiene supplies, therapeutic nutrition, and NFIs for safe water storage and household-level water treatment.
- **Facilitating access to services:** through mobile health clinics, maternal health services, nutrition screening, and referrals for protection needs.

The learning

In 2025, partners undertook two after action reviews (one led by the CERF-AHF and another by WFP) and a coordinated impact evaluation led by FAO (ongoing at the time of drafting this framework). For 2026, results from the ongoing impact evaluation will be drawn on.

Validity period

The present framework is valid for an initial period of two years following endorsement of the ERC (2026-2027).

1. Drought in Afghanistan

Afghanistan remains among the most climate-vulnerable countries globally, ranking as the seventh most vulnerable country to climate shocks per the [Notre Dame Global Adaptation Index](#) and fourth in the [INFORM Climate Change Risk Index](#). By 2030, annual droughts may become normal in many areas. Between 2020 and 2025, Afghanistan experienced repeated droughts, severely impacting coping capacities and drastically reducing groundwater levels, in some cases by up to 30 meters. In 2025, drought severely affected large parts of the northern and western regions, with approximately 3.4 million people affected in 12 provinces across at least 65 districts, impacting food production, livestock health and rural incomes.

Previous CERF drought allocations for Afghanistan have varied in size, with an average of \$12.3 million via the rapid response window. Funding requests were typically submitted in April-May or August-October periods.

Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec	Jan
Winter wet season		Spring wet season								Winter wet season		
		Spring wheat planting		Second season planting					Winter wheat planting			
		Poppy harvest		Wheat and barley harvest				Second season harvest (rice & maize)				
Lean season												
	Peak risk for spring flooding											

Afghanistan seasonal calendar (based on FEWSNET)

2. Coordination Arrangements

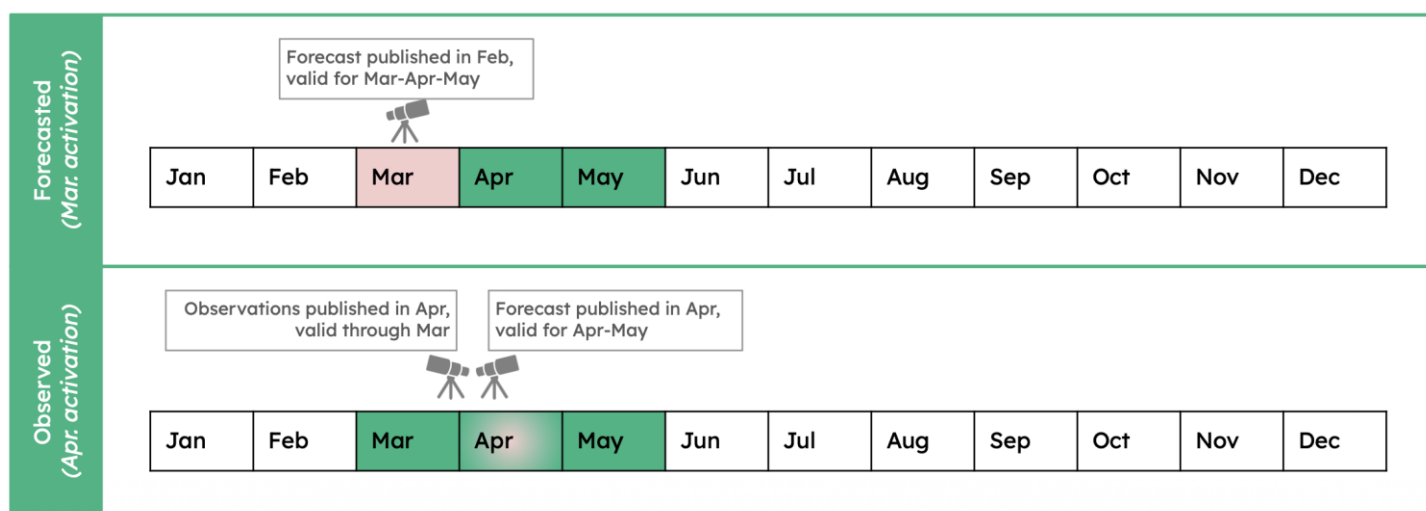
An AA Group, initially constituted following an invitation to interested partners through the HCT in late 2024 and comprising FAO, IOM, OCHA, UNFPA, UNICEF, UN Women, and WFP, has been leading the process. The Group also comprises and is supported by technical working groups of the Inter Cluster Coordination Team (ICCT) – Accountability to Affected Populations (AAP), Gender in Humanitarian Action (GiHA), Cash Working Group (CWG) – and sub-national coordination leads – Operational Coordination Teams (OCT) in the Northern and North-Eastern regions. In 2026, this Group additional NGO partners who partook in the delivery of the 2025 AA assistance post-activation (via funding from AHF). These partners contributed to evidence generation through the after-action review to inform the 2026 revision. A dedicated Trigger Sub-Group was also stood up in 5 to refine trigger threshold and timing parameters. For 2026, minor changes to the trigger moments and optimisation to the weighting of the combined drought index (for the April trigger moment) was applied based on the after action review discussions of the AA Group. The AAP Working Group and UNFPA (on behalf of the AA Group) coordinate early warning messaging and community engagement, aligning sector- and partner-specific communication channels. This extensive [Community Engagement and Early Warning Tracker](#) will be regularly updated and provides disaggregated data on the reach of early warning messages by district and population group. The Tracker additionally provides data on misinformation, challenges encountered during message sharing, and more importantly, feedback received from communities regarding the messages. The additional pieces of qualitative data will help address the gaps picked up in early warning messages dissemination in 2025. The CWG advises on aligning cash-based interventions, standardising transfer values and reducing duplication while ensuring complementarity with ongoing CVA interventions. WFP leads on MPCA through streamlined targeting criteria in addition to support on profiling target populations to identify Women Headed Households and Persons with Disabilities to ensure proportionate inclusion. For 2026, WFP has drawn lessons from the 2025 activation and will apply an improved targeting criteria for MPCA. FAO, on behalf of the AA Group, conducts ground truthing to supplement drought triggers through a rapid survey on what key informants in relevant provinces are witnessing.

Synergies with other initiatives

This framework aligns with the Afghanistan National Disaster Management Authority (ANDMA) 2025-2029 strategic plan for disaster management with identifies key hazards – including drought, the third most significant, which inflicts an estimated \$280 million in annual losses. This plan highlights preparedness measures, priorities, and resources, recognising OCHA and UN partners as strategic collaborators. In parallel, this coordinated AA framework coordinates with other anticipatory action initiatives currently under development such as those by the Afghan Red Crescent Society, IRC, Afghanistan and World Vision. In 2025, Education Cannot Wait made a complementary allocation in AA locations. Collaboration with the World Bank is underway to explore hosting the trigger model in the World Bank's Drought Decision Platform. Joint AA orientations have already been conducted with OCHA, partners, IFRC, in addition to engaging and raising awareness with relevant authorities at national and sub-national level.

3. Triggers and Thresholds

In early 2026, the AA Group decided to refine the trigger model in line with the revised geographic scope. For 2026, the trigger will be monitored across the merged cluster of five provinces. A two-stage trigger approach is maintained, with activation points in March or April. The trigger mechanism uses a combination of environmental metrics, seasonal rainfall forecast, observed rainfall, snow cover and vegetative health metrics with the threshold set based on historical analysis and estimated return periods.



Triggers thresholds

The financing and activities included in this framework will be activated by the triggers outlined in the table below.

Window	Indicator	Data Source	Evaluation time	Return period threshold
Window A (forecast-based)	Forecasted precipitation for Mar-Apr-May	ECMWF SEAS5 ²	Early March	1 in 6 years ³
Window B (observation- and forecast-based)	Composite drought indicator (composition outlined in table below)	Multiple	Early April	1 in 4 years ⁴

For each window, the trigger activates when the current indicator value exceeds the return period threshold for the merged five provinces.

Window A threshold is reached in March when the ECMWF SEAS5 forecasts precipitation for MAM to be below 129 mm, which corresponds to a 1-in-6-year rainfall deficit.

Window B threshold is reached in April when the optimized combined drought indicator (CDI) exceeds the threshold of 0.503, which corresponds to a 1-in-4-year return period.

For window B, the *composite drought indicator* is composed of the individual indicators in the table below. The individual indicators are combined⁵ using weights that were selected to optimize the trigger's accuracy.

Indicator	Data Source	Value used	Weight
Agricultural Stress Index (ASI)	FAO ⁶	End of March (Dekad 3)	20.6%
Vegetation Health Index (VHI)	FAO ⁷	End of March (Dekad 3)	19.2%
Combined observed and forecasted precipitation	ECMWF (ERA5 ⁸ and SEAS5)	Observation: March Forecast: April-May (issued April)	27.6%
Snow cover	ECMWF ERA5-LAND	March	20.5%
1-metre soil moisture	ECMWF ERA5	End of March	12.1%

The combined observed and forecasted precipitation indicator includes observed March precipitation (ERA5) and forecasted precipitation (SEAS5) for April and May published in April. All monthly values were normalized to z-score and then averaged together. The return period value for the windows are based on the analysis period of 1984-2025.. The first activation (window A or B) releases the full allocation amount. The allocation is not split across window A and B as in the previous version of the framework. The thresholds/return periods for merged AOI (5 provinces) are shown below:

AOI level	Window A	Window B	Combined RP
AOI (merged)	~1 in 6 year RP	~1 in 4 year RP	~1 in 4 year RP

Trigger activation protocol

Pre-defining the activation protocol is critical in order to avoid delays, miscommunication, uncertainty or errors once the trigger threshold is reached. For the Afghanistan drought AA framework, OCHA's Centre for Humanitarian Data (CHD) will monitor the indicators for both windows (forecast and observational indicators). The monitored data/results (whether trigger thresholds are reached or not reached) will be communicated to OCHA Afghanistan, the Afghanistan AA Group, CERF and the AHF via email. In case of activation, FAO will quickly conduct a ground-truthing exercise across the 23 prioritised districts (see next section 4. Geographical Prioritisation). This exercise will inform the identification of the most vulnerable districts, complementing monitoring data on current meteorological and hydrological conditions. With this information, OCHA Afghanistan will promptly organise the finalisation of the final-tier geographic prioritisation (see next section 4. Geographical Prioritisation) with UN and NGO partners and inform the HC/HCT, the ICCT and ANDMA of the activation.

Immediately following the CHD's notification of trigger thresholds reached, the CERF (based on ERC pre-approved projects) and AHF will send project approval letters to partners and disburse funding.

² High-resolution SEAS5 data is shared with CHD directly by ECMWF. A slightly lower-resolution product is available publicly at <https://cds.climate.copernicus.eu/datasets/seasonal-monthly-single-levels>

³ A 4.2-year return period corresponds to 10 out of 41 historical years triggering in each province

⁴ A 5.2-year return period corresponds to 8 out of 41 historical years triggering in each province.

⁵ Specifically, the indicators were combined by taking the Z-score of each indicator (reversed where relevant, so that a high value always corresponds to poor agricultural conditions), then combining them using a weighted average using the corresponding weights. The optimal weights were determined by iterating over all possible weight combinations at 5% intervals.

⁶ Data available publicly at: https://www.fao.org/giews/earthobservation/asis/data/country/AFG/MAP_ASI/DATA/ASI_Dekad_Season1_data.csv

⁷ Data available publicly at:

https://www.fao.org/giews/earthobservation/asis/data/country/AFG/MAP_NDVI_ANOMALY/DATA/vhi_adm1_dekad_data.csv

⁸ Data available publicly at: <https://cds.climate.copernicus.eu/datasets/reanalysis-era5-land-monthly-means>

Activation protocol

When	Who	What	How
Beginning of March or April	CHD	Monitors indicators for window A / B	ECMWF SEAS5 portal
When trigger threshold is reached	CHD	Notifies OCHA country office and HQ, Afghanistan AA Group, CERF and AHF.	Email
Once trigger notification is received	OCHA CO	OCHA country office – as HCT secretariat – will inform HC/HCT of activation.	Email
	CERF	Sends out approval letter authorizing agencies to use all funds.	Email
	AHF		
	FAO	Conduct quick ground truthing through field presence.	Technical field work
	OCHA CO, AAG	Determine final geographical prioritization to triage the target districts.	Meeting
Once target districts are selected	UN Agencies and NGOs	Implementation of AA activities per the framework and approved projects.	Direct implementation with partners

4. Geographical Prioritisation

Note: In a typical drought year in Afghanistan, affected areas span multiple provinces, most commonly in the western, northern and north-eastern regions, but often also extending to the central, eastern and southern parts of the country. Given the scale of potential impact, the geographic scope of the drought AA framework for monitoring and implementation purposes is deliberately limited, reflecting drought risks, underlying vulnerability as well as operational considerations and available financing. The methodology applied, and the resulting number of prioritised districts, does not necessarily represent the full extent of drought-affected areas at the time of activation. Rather, it reflects the operational and financial realities within which the AA Framework operates. With increased capacity and additional resources, it is intended to expand the geographic scope accordingly.

The geographical prioritisation for the AA framework follows a three-tiered approach:

a) Provincial Prioritisation:

Considering historical trends, a significant number of provinces in Afghanistan – spanning an arch from the western to northern and northeastern regions – have been affected by droughts. The AA Group conducted an analysis to determine priority provinces, factoring in:

- Areas with high percentages of rain-fed agricultural land (compared to irrigated land), as rain-fed agriculture is more vulnerable to droughts.
- Average yearly rainfall anomalies (2020–2023) and drought impact in 2025 to identify provinces already impacted by prolonged multi-year drought conditions, assuming these areas are still recovering from past drought effects.
- Provinces that show strong correlation in historical drought events, to identify a coherent cluster of provinces and reduce outliers.

Based on this analysis and consultations with regional partners, five priority provinces emerged: Balkh, Faryab, Jawzjan and Sar-e-Pul (Northern Region) and Badghis (Western Region).

b) District Prioritisation:

Given the large geographical coverage of the five provinces, further prioritisation was undertaken at district level. This was based on underlying vulnerability, reflected in existing inter-sectoral needs using the latest 2026 HNRP data. Within the five provinces, districts with inter-sectoral severity levels of 4 or above were selected as priority districts. Prioritizing people in districts with the highest inter-sectoral needs in Afghanistan ensures that those most in need are reached first, in line with the prioritisation approach of the Global Humanitarian Overview (GHO).

The list of 23 prioritised districts include:

- **Eleven** (11) districts in Faryab
- **Five** (5) districts in Jawzjan
- **Five** (5) districts in Sar-e-Pul
- **One** (1) district in Balkh
- **One** (1) district in Badghis

c) Final triaging of districts in the event of trigger activation

In the event of trigger activation, monitoring data on current meteorological and hydrological conditions, along with the results of ground-truthing conducted by FAO, will be partly used to identify the 10-15 most vulnerable districts where anticipatory actions will be implemented.

WFP will also share with the AA group its latest improved hotspot monitoring analysis which covers latest data on vulnerability (across multiple sectoral needs) and access. Where adequate data is provided, the final triaging of districts can take into account relevant vulnerability data, including food insecurity, nutrition, agriculture and livelihoods, health, and access to water, depending on the availability of updated and disaggregated datasets.



Household-level Targeting

AA Group partners agreed on coordinated, transparent vulnerability indicators for household-level targeting, along with clear geographic delineation, deduplication, and coordination measures. For the CERF and AHF-funded MPCA component, partners will decide on geographic delineation to avoid duplication of interventions. The MPCA targeting framework drew on WFP's targeting approach and existing population profiling as a common foundation. The targeting criteria for 2026 were refined in consultation with UN Women, UNICEF and AHF partners to ensure that the most vulnerable households are effectively reached. The resulting cash targeting framework was then compared with FAO's cash+ packages to minimise potential overlaps at the household level based on livestock holding criteria. Deduplication across the framework's activities and modalities – including sectoral, multisectoral, and Cash+ packages – was carefully considered along the following dimensions: pre-defined inclusion and exclusion criteria, distinct intended cash utilisation, geographic delineation; and package provision timelines, resulting in mutually exclusive targeting of affected populations by different partners in distinct locations or in adjusted complimentary packages. Partners also established internal operational considerations for joint assessments, registration and distribution and separately agreed on external collaboration with local authorities.

Female Participation, Gender and Disability Inclusion

The GiHA WG will support ensuring that all activities under the AA Framework are gender-responsive, with women's participation mainstreamed as a key component of every intervention. This includes providing direct technical advice to partners involved in the framework to ensure the gender-responsiveness of their activities. UN Women, as the co-chair of the GiHA WG will also coordinate with others under the AA Framework to ensure women and girls have access to anticipatory action. For example, UN Women is working UNFPA on tailored early warning messaging.

Inclusive and Adapted MPCA: In accordance with CWG minimum expenditure basket (MEB) guidance, which recommends a 15 per cent inclusion quota for women-headed households and 15 per cent quota for households with at least one person with a disability, framework partners delivering MPCA will apply a 20 per cent top-up to the standard transfer value for these groups. This measure aims to ensure that the cash assistance provided contributes to overcoming barriers that may otherwise hinder their access and meaningful participation.

5. Planned Activities

Selection criteria

Anticipatory actions aim to protect those most at risk before a shock hits/peaks. Actions selected followed these criteria:

- **Anticipatory character:** Activities effectively prevent or reduce the humanitarian impact of drought.
- **Feasible within the window of opportunity:** activities can be delivered within the lead time – i.e. between the trigger and peak of drought impact.
- **Operational capacity:** Partners have the necessary institutional (thematic, logistic, administrative, financial, human resources) capacity to implement these activities at scale within the lead time.
- **No regrets approach:** In case of a false alarm, proposed actions benefit (and not negatively affect) people targeted.

Objectives

The pre-agreed activities aim to mitigate the main humanitarian impacts of drought. They focus on:

- Enabling communities to take informed decisions
- Safeguarding agricultural production and reducing yield losses
- Avoiding deteriorating food security until harvest
- Sustaining animals to protect household livelihoods and avoid deterioration of malnutrition
- Ensuring availability of safe water for human and animal consumption
- Reducing the risk of disease outbreaks
- Reducing morbidity and mortality through access to essential goods and services
- Mitigating drought-related protection risks and use of negative coping strategies

Activities

The pre-agreed activities are:

- **Communicating risks, engaging with communities, and early warning messaging:** The Accountability to Affected Populations Working Group (AAPWG) has worked with partners under this framework to develop contextualized and sectoral early warning messages, targeted communication materials and identify effective communication channels, such as face-to-face engagement and radio programmes. The AAPWG is coordinating partners and streamline community engagement around drought. First, it has developed contextualized sector- and partner-specific messages so local communities receive consistent, accurate information. Second, it has identified appropriate communication channels – such as house-to-house visits and radio programmes – to ensure coverage of diverse population groups (including women, girls, and persons with disabilities). Third, the group is deploying its own resources (e.g., communication materials, technical guidance) to bolster outreach in each targeted district. Finally, it has formed a dedicated AA Community Engagement Task Team to oversee this process, gather feedback, and refine messaging including on people's intended cash utilisation based on evolving needs and insights from the field. A dedicated [online dashboard](#) tracks the dissemination of early warning messages to support coordination and provides access to key messages and related guidance.
- **Providing in-kind assistance:** A set of in-kind assistance activities such as the provision of food packages, emergency medical supplies (including severe acute malnutrition-SAM kits, reproductive health kits), nutrient-rich foods and therapeutic foods for malnutrition prevention and treatment, hygiene kits (soap, water purification tablets, menstrual hygiene products), safe water storage supplies.
- **Providing sectoral cash, multi-sectoral cash and integrated mixed modalities (cash+):** Multipurpose cash assistance (MPCA) is key component of the framework to provide affected households with the flexibility to prepare in accordance with their most pressing needs. This is complemented by cash for work (water conservation – rehabilitation) and cash + livestock protection packages. Women headed households and households with at least one member with a disability who are assessed as eligible for MPCA will receive a 20 per cent top-up in addition to the standard transfer value. *Note: Framework partners affirmed their alignment to cluster guidelines for sectoral cash and CWG guidance for MPCA and its entailed complementarity considerations.*
- **Facilitating access to services and replenishment of critical nutrition supplies:** The framework supports access to health services via deployment of mobile health clinics and teams for maternal, child, and general healthcare; maternal health and obstetric referrals; screening and referral for severe/moderate malnutrition; water testing and treatment; case management and referral for protection services (including gender-based violence-GBV); and infection prevention and disease surveillance services. Critical nutrition commodities for the treatment of SAM and high-risk MAM are replenished to avoid pipeline breaks and ensure that implementing partners are able to provide nutrition services.

Implementation timeline

	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec	Jan
Rainy season	Winter		Spring								Winter		
Peak drought impact													
Trigger moments		A		B									
Window A implementation			delivery of assistance										
Window B implementation					delivery of assistance								

The tables below summarise CERF and AHF-funded activities. Detailed budgets and numbers of targeted people can be found in the CERF Projects, AHF Allocation Strategy, and related proposals. All activities identified are critical and align with the lifesaving criteria of the 2025 HNRP reprioritisation (Strategic objective 1) as well as CERF/AHF's lifesaving focus.

CERF funded activities

Agency	Sector	Activities	People Targeted	Budget
FAO	Food Security-Agriculture	Cash+ Livestock Protection - PPR vaccines, Dewormer + CCHF	85,120	\$3,250,000
		Cash for work (water conservation - rehabilitation)		
		Ground Truthing		
		Early warning messaging and dissemination (SMS)		
UNFPA	Protection	Distribution of Dignity Kits to Women of Reproductive age and adolescent girls.	15,069	\$375,000
		Distribution and Replenishment of MHM kits to adolescent girls.		
		Conducting orientation session for health service providers on PSEA.		
	Health-SRH	Dissemination of early warning messages	103,000	\$375,000
		Distribution and Replenishment of IEHK for provision of life-saving services		
		Distribution and Replenishment of Clean Delivery Kits		
UNICEF	WASH	Procurement and distribution of water tanks to selected household	12,600	\$700,000
		Procurement and distribution of household water treatment units to the selected families		
		Conduct hygiene promotion, community mobilization and distribution of water purification tablets		
	Nutrition	Distribution of therapeutic supplies (RUTF) to treatment points in priority districts	5,371	\$300,000
		Provision of life-saving treatment services to children aged 6 - 59 months affected by SAM		
WFP	MPC	Distribution of MPCA to selected beneficiaries	153,560	\$6,020,000
	Nutrition	Procure and dispatch specialized nutrition commodities.	15,555	\$980,000
		Children aged 6–59 months and PBWGs receive specialized nutritious foods that treat MAM.		
Total				\$12,000,000

AHF funded activities

Sector	Partner ⁹	Indicative Funding ¹⁰	
Health & Nutrition		\$2m	- Free referral for obstetrical complications - Mobile Health & Nutrition Teams for screening & treatment of acute malnutrition - Counseling & community awareness on maternal, infant and young child nutrition (MIYCN) - Monitoring of Breast Milk Substitutes & code adherence - Transportation support to Therapeutic Feeding Units
WASH		\$1.5m	- Emergency water supply (rehabilitation/installation of wells, boreholes, storage tanks) - Safe water storage & household-level water treatment - Water conservation (rainwater harvesting, groundwater recharge) - Distribution of hygiene kits (soap, purification tablets, menstrual products) - Sanitation & hygiene promotion
Protection		\$0.5m	- Case management (GBV, child protection, general protection) - Cash for protection for high-risk individuals - Distribution of dignity kits - Civil documentation for women returnees & female-headed households - Referral to essential services
Emergency Agriculture		\$1m	- Livestock protection -
Multi-Sector /MPCA		\$5m	- Single tranche MPCA cash distribution aligned with CWG Minimum Expenditure Basket including top-ups for WHH and PwD

⁹ AHF partner selection will be finally confirmed after the Advisory Board's review and approval of the AA Allocation Strategy and review committee's evaluations of project proposals; the framework document will be updated accordingly.

¹⁰ AHF funding envelopes are indicative and will also only be final after the above.

6. Pre-agreed Financing

Central Emergency Response Fund (CERF)

For this anticipatory action framework in Afghanistan, the ERC has pre-agreed to allocate *up to* \$12 million from the Central Emergency Response Fund (CERF) if triggers are reached.

CERF will disburse funds per window once three conditions are met:

- Endorsement by the Humanitarian Coordinator of the framework and the CERF application package, including agency project proposals and budgets and
- Endorsement by the Emergency Relief Coordinator of the finalised framework, as well as the CERF agency project proposals and budgets; and
- Activation of the pre-agreed triggers once the framework is fully approved and operational until end 2026.

CERF will disburse funds on a no-regrets basis as soon as the respective trigger is reached. Upon activation of any trigger, CERF will send out approval letters to the relevant agencies and subsequently will disburse all the funds for the respective activation moment¹¹. Further details can be found in the CERF project documents and CERF communications. Any changes to the projects and budgets have to be approved by the CERF Secretariat as per usual practice.

Having an anticipatory action framework supported by CERF neither precludes (nor guarantees) additional CERF Rapid Response funding to a country for the same or other shocks.

Afghanistan Humanitarian Fund (AHF)

AHF launches a \$10 million allocation under the joint \$22 million CERF–AHF Anticipatory Action framework for drought in 2026 (CERF: \$12M; AHF: \$10M). The allocation aims to:

Mitigate drought impacts before crisis thresholds are reached through trigger-based early financing.

Protect lives, livelihoods and dignity in the most climate-exposed, severity 4+ districts.

Deliver integrated, household-level support, centered on multipurpose cash and early warning, complemented by agriculture, WASH, nutrition, health and protection measures.

Enhance speed, predictability and coherence of pooled fund responses under a unified AA framework aligned with the 2026 HNRP.

Lessons applied from 2025: simplified trigger activation, tighter geographic targeting, and streamlined response packages—making anticipatory action (AA) more operational, scalable and fit-for-purpose in Afghanistan’s climate-risk context.

To expedite the allocation process and leverage existing partner operations, 10 NGOs (5 international NGOs and 5 national NGOs) have been pre-identified and invited to submit proposals as the best placed partners based on their operational capacity in AA in affected areas.

Both funds are strategically aligned under the revised Anticipatory Action (AA) Framework, ensuring harmonized geographic prioritization, synchronized timelines, and coordinated partner engagement. The framework also actively promotes complementary financing. Partners are encouraged to mobilize both AA-specific and non-AA co-financing to reinforce prioritized geographic areas through a layered, multi-sectoral response. In 2025, this approach yielded tangible results: UN Agencies, Funds and Programmes mobilized an additional \$3.6 million in complementary funding—spanning both AA and non-AA streams—targeted to the same high-risk districts. Furthermore, Education Cannot Wait contributed \$0.5 million to the Agha Khan Foundation, strengthening the education component within the broader drought response architecture.

This catalytic financing model demonstrates how pooled funds can serve as strategic anchors—crowding in additional resources, enhancing coherence. Cash-Based interventions, and enhanced humanitarian access throughout project design and implementation.

Learning, monitoring and evaluation

This framework offers significant opportunities to both generate and apply learning, thus contributing to the overall improvement of humanitarian action in response to slow-onset shocks.

Each agency will use its existing monitoring & evaluation systems to collect and track data on implementation progress and outputs achieved. All findings will be shared. In addition, partners have agreed to conduct a joint Post Distribution Monitoring (PDM) in case of a framework activation. All UN agencies receiving CERF funding agreed to share data on targeted people, within existing regulations, and commit to providing relevant inputs to support the PDM. The final PDM report along with data will be made available to all framework partners. The PDM will be done in close coordination and communication with participating agencies.

Similar to 2025, an after-action review will further be conducted to gather lessons learned from the development and potential implementation of the framework. Partners have also planned a broader / coordinated impact evaluation in 2026. This will supplement the ongoing impact evaluation by FAO (from late 2025) on behalf of AA implementing partners. Further

¹¹ While approval letters will be sent out immediately following an activation, the administrative transfer of funds to agencies may be delayed by a few days. To avoid a delay in project implementation, agencies confirm their ability to frontload the resources required to initiate their response until the funding has been received.

discussions could take place for an independent evaluation in 2026, capitalising on OCHA-WFP five year MoU on impact evaluations focusing on AA.

7. Validity and Future of the Framework

The present framework is valid for an initial period of about two years following endorsement of the ERC (2026-2027). If the framework activates in 2026, lessons learned from the implementation of the framework will be applied to improve the framework for 2027 in collaboration with the AA Group.

8. Annexes

Technical Note

The framework uses a two-window trigger with OR logic: activation occurs if either window's threshold is breached. Window A (March) evaluates the ECMWF SEAS5 forecasted March-April-May precipitation against a 1-in-6-year return period threshold (≤ 129 mm). Window B (April) evaluates a composite drought indicator (CDI) combining five z-score standardised inputs (ASI, VHI, blended observed/forecast precipitation, snow cover, and soil moisture) against a 1-in-4-year return period threshold (≥ 0.503). All indicators are aggregated to a single regional value using an area-weighted mean across the five provinces. The combined activation frequency is approximately 1-in-4 years.

Thresholds and indicator weights were derived from 42 years of historical data (1984 to 2025). For the purpose of model training and evaluation, drought years are defined as those in which the FAO end-of-season Agricultural Stress Index (ASI) exceeds its empirical 1-in-4-year return period. For the March window, we tested multiple configurations; pre-season observational indicators (February snow cover, soil moisture, cumulative precipitation) did not improve skill when combined with the SEAS5 forecast, so the forecast is used as a standalone indicator. For the April window, CDI component weights were estimated using ridge regression. Both windows were validated with leave-one-out cross-validation (LOOCV), where each year's trigger decision is made from a model trained without that year's data. The April CDI achieves a cross-validated F1 of 0.82, identifying 9 of 10 historical drought years with 2 false activations.

Monitoring is conducted by the Centre for Humanitarian Data via an automated pipeline that retrieves SEAS5 forecasts in March and observational inputs for the CDI in April.

Core principles

Each anticipatory action framework is tailored to the local context. OCHA has identified nine core principles that should apply to the framework in Afghanistan:

- **Prioritizing a multi-sectoral approach:** Partners should prioritise multi-sectoral, co-targeted interventions, when possible, to maximise synergies and to achieve great impact.
- **Ensuring the centrality of protection:** In line with the IASC centrality of protection policy, and the principle of “leaving no one behind” (2030 Agenda), all partners implementing anticipatory interventions have the responsibility to ensure that their response will not aggravate the exposure of communities to risks of violence, insecurity, extortion and exploitation. Anticipatory actions must also ensure that they benefit all communities (local communities, displaced communities, returnees, and refugees) based on their needs, with due attention given to obstacles linked to gender, age, disability or social affiliation.
- **Ensuring gender equality is central to inclusive and accountable anticipatory action:** In line with IASC Policy on Gender Equality and the Empowerment of Women and Girls in Humanitarian Action, all partners are responsible and accountable to ensure humanitarian action, including anticipatory action is: rights-based; recognises gender-based and intersectional needs, as well as potential gender-based discrimination in access to resources and services; facilitate leadership and contribution of crisis-affected women and girls in the planning, implementation, monitoring and evaluation of anticipatory actions and early response, that directly impact their lives and those of their dependents and wider communities.
- **Promoting accountability to affected populations and the Protection from Sexual Exploitation and Abuse (PSEA):** Partners engaged in the implementation of the anticipatory action framework are responsible for the integration of accountability to affected populations approaches in their activities. This includes making all efforts to solicit, hear, and act upon the voices and priorities of affected people (including the most marginalised and at-risk women, men, girls and boys) in a coordinated manner, before, during, and after anticipatory action. It also means ensuring that community feedback leads to corrective action in future anticipatory action.
- **Supporting localisation:** All partners involved in the implementation of this framework are expected to honor the HCT's commitment towards localisation. Equitable partnerships with local actors building upon their long-term relationships and trust with communities during anticipatory action are crucial.
- **Engaging in partnerships:** Collaboration across humanitarian actors is key to ensuring that all sectors are engaged, and that assistance is mobilised according to the AA framework.

- **Generating development and climate adaptation co-benefits:** Pilot participants are encouraged to consider how financing for anticipatory action can complement financing for development by reducing suffering and addressing the root causes of problems while supporting adaptation to climate change.
- **Capturing learning:** Monitoring, evaluation and learning activities should be embedded at every phase of the development and implementation of the AA framework.
- **Striving for integration:** The framework seeks to integrate the anticipatory action activities into the existing humanitarian architecture and to foster linkages with long term programming, including resilience and development initiatives.

Annex: Contact List

Agency	Name	Role	Email
UNICEF	Maria Giordano	Senior Emergency Specialist	mgjordano@unicef.org
UNICEF	Kenneth Anyanzo	Social Policy Specialist	kanyanzo@unicef.org
UNICEF	Adane Bekele	WASH Manager	adbekele@unicef.org
UNICEF	Ahmad Seyar Haqmal	WASH Specialist	ahaqmal@unicef.org
UNICEF	Muqadar Shah Hashimi	Social Policy Specialist	shashimi@unicef.org
UNICEF	Arzi Hussain Akhgar	Social Policy Officer	aakhgar@unicef.org
WFP	Pauline Eloff	Emergency Manager	pauline.eloff@wfp.org
WFP	Jessica Kim	Head of Cash-based Transfers	jessica.kim@wfp.org
WFP	Zabihullah Wahdati	Programme Policy Officer (Resilience)	zabihullah.wahdati@wfp.org
WFP	Alexander Riley	Programme Policy Officer (Emergencies)	alexander.riley@wfp.org
WFP	El Masry Moataz	Programme Policy Officer (Early Warning & GIS)	moataz.elmasry@wfp.org
FAO	Sylvie Montembault	Head of Monitoring, Analysis and Strategic Communications	Sylvie.Montembault@fao.org
FAO	Devale, Kaustubh	Head of Programmes	Kaustubh.Devale@fao.org
FAO	Sadat, Wahidullah	Anticipatory Action Support Assistant	Wahidullah.Sadat@fao.org
UNFPA	Ana Maria Leal	Humanitarian Coordinator	leal@unfpa.org
UNFPA	Hazrat Amin	Humanitarian Access Officer	haamin@unfpa.org
UNFPA/AAPWG	Fazly Ahmadullah	AAP Specialist	fazly@unfpa.org
UNFPA	Abdul Wasi Stanikzai	AAP Specialist	stanikzai@unfpa.org
OCHA AFG/SCU	Pascal Pillokeit	Humanitarian Affairs Officer	pascal.pillokeit@un.org
OCHA AFG/SCU	Rami Beirkdar	Humanitarian Affairs Officer / Cash Coordination	mohammed.beirkdar@un.org
OCHA AFG/AHF	Serin Hetou	Humanitarian Affairs Officer / Programme & Data Management Lead	hetou@un.org
OCHA AFG/IMU	Sandeep Bashyal	Information Management Officer	bashyal@un.org
OCHA AFG/FCAU	Mirwais Muzafar	Humanitarian Affairs Officer / NR&NER	muzafar@un.org
OCHA AFG/FCAU	Shahrukh Pazhman	Humanitarian Affairs Officer / WR	pazhman@un.org
OCHA HQ/CIS	Billie Getachew	Humanitarian Affairs Officer	getachewalemayehu@un.org
OCHA CHD	Zachary Arno	Data Scientist	zachary.arno@un.org
OCHA CERF	Yakubu Alhassan	Anticipatory Action Specialist	yakubu.alhassan@un.org
OCHA CERF	Regina Omlor	CERF AA Lead	regina.omlor@un.org
OCHA CERF	Nico Rost	CERF Head of Unit	rostn@un.org
OCHA ROAP	Maya Manocsoc	Humanitarian Affairs Officer	maya.manocsoc@un.org